

Step 4

- **Examine** - Take a moral inventory of yourself and decisions that you've made.
 - (Lamentations 3:40) says ***"Let us examine our ways and test them, and let us return to the Lord"***
 - (2 Corinthians 13:5) says ***"Examine yourselves to see whether you are in the faith; test yourselves. Do you not realize that Christ Jesus is in you—unless, of course, you fail the test?"***

The word **examine** comes from the Greek word, *peirazo*, which means to "scrutinize and try."

In addition to that, Paul said to **test yourselves**. Now, the Greek word used in the word **test** is *dokimazo*, which is a stronger term compared to the Greek word *peirazo*. It means "to test as to metals".

One of the hardest things for a person to do is **examine** themselves. It is EASY for us to examine others and see the things that would make them "better people" or "better Christians". But for us to look into the mirror and do the same... That is an entirely different story..

Examining ourselves, no matter how hard it is to do, IS a necessity in our lives. Looking deep down (sometimes not even too deep) into our hearts and finding those things that are keeping us from being who God has called us to be, the freedom He has given us, as well as doing the things God has called us to do IS a practice we all must develop.

We know we have things, unclean things, in our lives that we need to get out but sometimes, we lack the *courage* or even the *willingness* to examine ourselves.

Know and understand this promise in scripture -

Matthew 5:8 *Blessed are the pure in heart, for they will see God.*

3 Effective Way To Examine Yourself

1. Examine Your Faith - *1 Corinthians 13:5*
2. Examine Your Works - *Galatians 6:3-5*
3. Examine Yourself Through Gods' Perspective Of Being Your Heavenly Father - *Psalms 139:23-24*

Examine and confess my faults to myself, to God and to someone I trust.

What wrongs, resentments, or secret sins are keeping you awake at night? Wouldn't you like to get rid of them?

What value do you see in confessing, in coming clean of the wreckage of your past?

What results do you expect God to produce in your life?

What freedom do you feel because of the words of Romans 8:1 and Romans 3:23-24?
What specifically do these phrases "No condemnation" and "not guilty" mean to you?

Once you have examined yourself, you will find four areas of your life beginning to improve. You will be able to **face the truth, ease the pain, stop the blame, and start accepting God's forgiveness**. What areas of your life will each of these four positive changes help your recovery?

I can be more honest with...

I can ease my pain by...

I can stop blaming...

Can accept God's forgiveness because of...